



SOFT-GOODS PACKAGING SPEC

Quality Firewood & Materials · how we pack and ship the woven goods line · companion to the Fulfillment SOP · July 2026

THE FIVE RULES OF SOFT-GOODS PACKING

1. **If it folds flat by design, it ships in a bag; if it holds a shape, it ships in a box.** No exceptions for "just this once."
2. **Soft packs ship USPS Ground Advantage ONLY.** UPS surcharges any non-corrugated pack over 18 inches (\$25+); anything going UPS goes in a corrugated box.
3. **Every unit gets its clear inner bag and SKU label the moment the master carton opens.** The carton goes back to its spot with the remaining count written large on the outside, and only one carton per SKU is ever open.
4. **Rolled rugs: fold first, so the roll is 30 inches or less — never over 48.** Every inch past 30 costs \$10 at USPS; past 48 costs \$25+ at UPS.
5. **No vacuum compression, ever — and nothing gets bagged damp.** Natural fibers keep creases and grow mildew. Air the item out, then seal.

PACKAGING BY ITEM CLASS

itemClass	innerPack	outerPack	methodNotes	pkgCost	shipWeight
Napkin ring set	Clear poly bag + tissue	10x13 poly mailer, 2.5 mil	Rings nested and tied; care card in the bag	~\$0.30	Under 1 lb
Placemat set	Clear poly bag + tissue	12x15.5 or 14.5x19 mailer	Flat stack — keep flat, never folded	~\$0.35	1–3 lb
Collapsible basket	Clear poly bag + tissue	14.5x19 mailer (24x24 for large)	Fold flat as designed; ships USPS only	~\$0.40	2–5 lb
Rigid / shaped basket	Tissue + kraft void fill	Corrugated box, snug fit	Never bagged — crush risk; box is fine on UPS	~\$2.50	3–8 lb
3x5 flatweave rug	6-mil poly tube bag, ends taped	(the bag is the outer)	Fold in half, roll to 30 in or less; care card inside	~\$0.60	5–8 lb + \$4.50 fee
8x10 rug	6-mil tube or sheeting, strapped	(the bag is the outer)	Fold in thirds, roll to 48 in or less; check length plus girth under 108; quote USPS and UPS both ways	~\$1.50	25–40 lb + fees

WHY BAGS WIN — THE NUMBERS

A 3x5 flatweave rug (about 6 lb): folded in half, rolled to 30 inches, and shipped in a poly tube bag runs about \$18.78 in postage. The same rug in a tube box bills at 11 lb dimensional weight, takes the \$10 over-30-inch fee, and costs the box itself — roughly \$32–34 shipped. The bag saves \$13–15 per rug, about 40%. Small items save \$3–4 per shipment the same way: a soft pack collapses around the product and almost never triggers dimensional-weight billing; a box nearly always measures bigger than what is inside it.

The fee cliffs that set the folding and rolling rules:

carrier	trigger	fee
USPS Ground Advantage	Any side over 22 in (up to 30)	\$4.50
USPS Ground Advantage	Any side over 30 in	\$10.00
USPS Ground Advantage	Volume over 2 cu ft	\$21.00 (fees stack)
UPS	Soft pack (not corrugated) over 18 in	\$25+ additional handling
UPS	Any side over 48 in	\$25+ additional handling, 40 lb minimum billed



OPENING A MASTER CARTON — THE REPACK RITUAL

Our soft goods arrive several units to a carton, and orders ship one unit at a time. The ten minutes spent when a carton first opens makes every later pick a sixty-second grab-and-seal:

- 1. Bag and label at once.** The moment a master carton opens, every unit goes into its clear inner bag and gets a SKU label — scannable code plus the code written plainly. Loose unlabeled soft goods in the same weave family are indistinguishable.
- 2. Count on the carton.** The carton returns to its bin with the remaining quantity written large on the outside ("QTY 7 of 12"), crossed down as units leave.
- 3. One open carton per SKU.** Never two partial cartons of the same item. Finish one before opening the next.
- 4. Split mixed cartons.** A carton holding more than one SKU is separated into per-SKU bags before it goes to storage — never stored commingled.

SUPPLIES SHOPPING LIST

item	sizeSpec	unitCost
Poly mailers — small	10x13, 2.5 mil (napkin rings, small goods)	\$0.08–0.12
Poly mailers — workhorse	14.5x19, 2.5 mil (placemats, baskets, folded flatweaves)	\$0.13–0.16
Poly mailers — large	24x24, 2.5–3 mil (large baskets, folded rugs)	\$0.35–0.50
Poly tubing roll	6 mil, 12–16 in wide — cut-to-length rug bags	\$0.30–1.50 per rug
Clear flat poly bags	1.5 mil, 12x15 and 18x24 (inner bags)	\$0.04–0.10
Tissue paper + stickers	20x30 sheets	\$0.10–0.20 per order
Thank-you / care cards	4x6 printed — creases-relax note and reorder code	\$0.05–0.15
Packing + strapping tape	2 in acrylic, filament for rug ends	~\$0.10 per shipment
SKU labels	2x3 thermal	~\$0.01

Packaging cost per shipment: napkin rings ~\$0.30 · placemats ~\$0.35 · collapsible basket ~\$0.40 · 3x5 rug ~\$0.60 · 8x10 rug ~\$1.50.
Prices and carrier fees are as of July 2026 and move often — always verify the live rate in the shipping platform at label time.